PREMIER LEAGUE 2026/27 · MATCHWEEK 5

Brentford v Chelsea

Gtech Community Stadium, London · September 18, 2026 (Friday) · Kickoff 2:00 PM Central / 20:00 UK

OFFICIAL STARTING XI

NO.	PLAYER / POSITION	FROM	AT CHELSEA	PREVIOUSLY	PLAYING STYLE	KEY STATS
1 GK	**Emiliano Martínez** GOALKEEPER	Argentina	August 2026, £7.5m from Aston Villa — signed the morning…	Aston Villa; Arsenal; loans at Oxford United, Sheffield…	World Cup winner and a renowned penalty specialist — commanding, vocal, and a serial big-moment goalkeeper.	2025–26, ASTON VILLA 95 saves, 32 apps
33 RCB	**Wesley Fofana** CENTRE-BACK	France	Since Aug 2022, about £70m from Leicester City	Leicester City; Saint-Étienne	Quick, aggressive and front-footed, strong in single combat and comfortable defending a high line.	2025–26, CHELSEA 25 apps, 1,727 minutes
5 CB	**Maxence Lacroix** CENTRE-BACK	France	July 2026, about £52m ($69m) from Crystal Palace	Crystal Palace; Wolfsburg; Sochaux	Reportedly the fastest centre-back in the Premier League by top speed.	2025–26, CRYSTAL PALACE 35 apps (all starts), 11 clean sheets
6 LCB	**Levi Colwill** LEFT CENTRE-BACK	England	Academy from 2012; first team since 2023 — 4th senior…	Chelsea academy; Huddersfield Town & Brighton (loans)	Left-footed, unflustered, progresses the ball through the left channel rather than sideways around it.	2025–26, CHELSEA — ACL RECOVERY 4 apps
7 RWB	**Pedro Neto** WINGER	Portugal	Since July 2024, about £54m from Wolves	Wolverhampton Wanderers; Lazio; Braga academy	Direct, one-v-one dribbler who attacks the byline and cuts back.	2025–26, CHELSEA 5 goals, 6 assists
14 CM	**Jordan Henderson** CENTRAL MIDFIELD	England	Summer 2026, from Brentford	Brentford; Ajax; Al-Ettifaq; Liverpool; Sunderland; Coventry…	Veteran organiser and senior voice rather than a ball-carrier — screens in front of the defence, sets the tempo with early sideways and forward…	2025–26, BRENTFORD 34 apps
– CM	**Valentin Barco** LEFT WING-BACK	Argentina	2026	Brighton; Sevilla and Strasbourg (loans); Boca Juniors	Left-footed wing-back with a fine delivery and a low centre of gravity.	2025–26, STRASBOURG 3 goals, 43 apps
29 LWB	**Pep Chavarría** LEFT WING-BACK	Spain	July 2026 from Rayo Vallecano	Rayo Vallecano; Real Zaragoza	Attacking left wing-back with a reliable delivery and real stamina up and down the flank.	2025–26, RAYO VALLECANO 2 assists, 33 apps
10 AM	**Cole Palmer** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	Since Sept 2023, £40m — 4th season	Manchester City (academy and first team)	Left-footed, drifts inside from the right, arrives late into the box, ice-cold from the penalty spot.	2025–26, CHELSEA 10 goals, 1 assist
17 AM	**Morgan Rogers** ATTACKING MIDFIELD	England	July 2026, £117m ($157m) from Aston Villa — club record…	Aston Villa; Middlesbrough; Manchester City academy; loans…	Powerful, low-slung ball carrier who takes possession on the half-turn and drives straight at defenders, and presses like a midfielder.	2025–26, ASTON VILLA 10 goals, 6 assists
– ST	**Danny Welbeck** CENTRE-FORWARD	England	2026	Brighton; Watford; Arsenal; Manchester United	Experienced forward who presses intelligently and holds the ball up.	2025–26, BRIGHTON 14 goals, 40 apps

Official starting XI, confirmed 1:23 PM CT. Last updated September 18, 2026, 1:23 PM CT. chelsea-fc-2026-27.netlify.app